

Lincoln Design Supplementary Planning Document (SPD)

1.0 Introduction

This Supplementary Planning Document (SPD) provides detailed guidance to support Policy D1 of the Lincoln Local Plan 2023-2040. It is a material consideration in the determination of planning applications.

2.0 Character Area Analysis

All major planning applications and applications within Conservation Areas must be supported by a detailed Character Area Analysis. This analysis must identify the key defining features of the immediate context, including plot widths, building lines, roofscapes, and predominant materials. The proposed design must respond directly and positively to these identified features.

3.0 Building Heights and Massing

Building heights must be proportionate to the width of the adjacent street. As a general rule, the building height should not exceed the width of the street to ensure adequate daylight, sunlight, and a sense of enclosure without being overbearing. Within the historic core, new development should generally not exceed 3 to 4 storeys unless robust justification can be provided demonstrating no adverse impact on key strategic views, particularly those of Lincoln Cathedral.

4.0 Materials Palette

For developments within the Lincoln city centre and adjacent Conservation Areas, the materials palette must reflect the traditional vernacular. Acceptable materials include red multi-stock brick, natural stone (limestone), natural slate for roofs, and clay pantiles. The use of large expanses of render or inappropriate modern cladding materials will be strongly resisted.

5.0 Frontage Activation

To ensure vibrant and safe streets, development along principal routes must incorporate active frontages. Ground floor uses should include entrances, large windows, and activity-generating uses. Blank, inactive facades exceeding 5 metres in length along street frontages will not be acceptable.

6.0 Parking Design Standards

Parking must be seamlessly integrated into the development and not dominate the street scene. For residential developments, communal parking areas must be well-landscaped and overlooked by habitable rooms to provide passive surveillance. A minimum of 1 secure, covered cycle parking space per bedroom must be provided.